

Call for Papers: Special issue

Ethics, Governance and Organizational Resilience in an Era of persistent Crisis: Rethinking Business & Societal Transformation

In collaboration with the InnoVision 2026 Conference - Rethinking Business in the Era of Complexity: Foresight, Leadership, and Innovation, hosted by GBSB Global Business School, Spain & Malta; Sanjivani University, India & MESOS Business School, France

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Special Issue Rationale

Persistent, interconnected crises challenge assumptions about organizational stability, predictability, and adaptation. Organizations confront geopolitical conflict, climate disruption, technological transformation, cyber threats, pandemics, economic volatility, and societal polarization. These pressures reshape value creation, stakeholder relations, governance, and legitimacy. Yet there are limited studies on how ethical governance mechanisms shape responses to prolonged crises (Apffelstaedt, Schrage, & Gilbert, 2024).

In this special issue we argue that in this context resilience extends beyond operational recovery to an organizational competence grounded in ethical governance, responsible leadership, stakeholder engagement, and sustainable value creation. Key questions concern how transparency, accountability, environmental stewardship, and social responsibility become governance practices that sustain trust and performance.

Challenges remain in sustaining ethical governance across organizational and societal contexts. Leaders must balance stakeholder expectations (Pless, Sengupta, Wheeler, & Maak, 2022), short-term pressures, and long-term societal objectives under ambiguity and resource constraints. Governance should therefore be examined as an adaptive process supporting resilience, legitimacy, accountability, and responsible leadership.

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This special issue advances interdisciplinary scholarship on business ethics, governance, organizational resilience, and societal transformation. We invite research on how private, public, and non-profit organizations develop ethical governance and resilient practices amid global challenges, including responsible leadership, stakeholder governance, ESG, crisis management, humanitarian and post-conflict governance, digital transformation, and artificial intelligence.

Across these themes, submissions should explicitly examine the interplay between ethical governance, organizational resilience, and societal transformation:

- **Ethical Governance and Organizational Legitimacy**

How can governance systems balance ethical responsibilities with organizational performance under uncertainty and institutional complexity (Snyder, Hall, Robertson, Jasinski, & Miller, 2006)? Which mechanisms strengthen legitimacy, accountability, and transparency in fragile environments? How can cross-sector collaboration and governance innovation support ethical practice during disruption?

- **Responsible Leadership and Ethical Decision-Making**

How do leaders navigate stakeholder expectations, moral dilemmas, and strategic trade-offs during crises (Menghwar, Homberg, Zaidi, & Alam, 2026)? Which capabilities foster ethical judgement, responsible decisions, and resilience under uncertainty in the era of generative AI (Hiebert & Kumar, 2026)? How can leadership strengthen trust, accountability, and long-term societal value?

- **Organizational Resilience, Adaptive Capacity, and Strategic Renewal**

How should organizational resilience be conceptualized beyond business continuity and operational recovery (Hernaez et al., 2023)? What roles do adaptive governance, organizational learning, strategic vigilance, and transformational change play in strengthening organizational resilience? How can organizations anticipate, absorb, and adapt to increasingly complex and interconnected crises?

- **Stakeholder Governance, Trust, and Social Legitimacy**

How are competing stakeholder interests negotiated and reconciled? How do organizations build trust, legitimacy, and engagement across social, institutional, and cultural contexts? Which governance approaches enable dialogue and shared value while addressing power asymmetries and conflict?

- **Business Ethics in Fragile, Humanitarian, and Post-Conflict Contexts**

How do organizations maintain ethical standards while operating in fragile institutional environments, humanitarian emergencies, and post-conflict societies (Oetzel, Westermann-

Behaylo, Koerber, Fort, & Rivera, 2009)? What governance arrangements support responsible reconstruction, peacebuilding, institutional recovery, and sustainable development (Cechvala & Ganson, 2024)? How can businesses, governments, NGOs, and international organizations collaborate to promote resilience, ethical governance, and long-term societal well-being?

- **Sustainability, ESG, and Responsible Value Creation**

How are environmental, social, and governance (ESG) principles embedded within organizational governance and strategic decision-making? What governance models promote sustainable value creation, responsible innovation, climate resilience, and inclusive growth (Duque-Grisales & Aguilera-Caracuel, 2021; Tungtapanpong & Postoyeva, 2023)? How can organizations translate ESG commitments (Aouadi & Marsat, 2018) into measurable organizational and societal outcomes? (Mallik, 2025)

- **Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation, and Ethical Governance**

How should organizations govern artificial intelligence, digital transformation, and emerging technologies responsibly (Borah, 2026)? What ethical challenges arise from algorithmic decision-making, data governance, automation, cybersecurity, and digital innovation (Martin, 2019)? How can organizations balance technological advancement with transparency, accountability, fairness, and stakeholder trust?

- **Entrepreneurship, Innovation, and Societal Transformation**

How do entrepreneurial initiatives contribute to organizational resilience, social innovation, and sustainable development? What roles do social, institutional, and public entrepreneurship play in addressing complex societal challenges (Fernhaber & Zou, 2022)? How can entrepreneurial ecosystems promote inclusive innovation while balancing economic, environmental, and social objectives?

- **Ethical Project Governance and Managing Complexity**

How can project governance be adapted to increasingly complex, uncertain, and crisis-prone environments? What ethical challenges emerge in the governance of humanitarian operations, infrastructure projects, megaprojects, and international development initiatives (Li, Fang, Zhang, Li, & Liu, 2026)? How can project management strengthen resilience, stakeholder coordination, and responsible organizational performance?

- **Responsible Management Education and Organizational Learning**

How can business schools and higher education institutions prepare future leaders to navigate ethical complexity and organizational uncertainty (Russo, Wheeldon, Shrestha, & Saratchandra, 2023)? What roles do service-learning, sustainability education, experiential

learning, and interdisciplinary collaboration play in developing responsible leadership competencies? How can management education, faculty development, and organizational learning contribute to more ethical, resilient, and socially responsible organizations (Solitander et al., 2012; Dyllick, 2015)?

Submission Guidelines

- See author guidelines: <https://journal.bmu.edu.in/submission-guidelines>
- Manuscripts must represent original, unpublished work and should not be under review at any other journal or publication outlet.
- All submissions will be subject to a double-blind peer review process, conducted in accordance with the editorial policies and ethical standards of *JBES*.
- Authors should submit a 1,000-word extended abstract by 31st October 2026 to research.centre@gbsb.global.
- Selected abstracts will be invited to submit a full manuscript by 15 December, 2026
- Expected publication: April, 2027
- Please clearly indicate “*InnoVision 2026 Special Issue*” in the cover letter accompanying your submission.
- Submissions are open to all scholars and are not conditional upon participation in the InnoVision 2026 Conference.

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